Task 02: Prompting for Creativity

Goal: design a prompt for creative output (startup ideas), use few-shot examples to guide style, run multiple variants and compare tone, creativity and detail.

Variant A: Zero-shot (baseline)

```
Give me 3 startup ideas for college students.
```

Output

- A campus food delivery app.
- A peer tutoring marketplace.
- A notes-sharing platform.

Observation: correct but generic, one line each, ideas that already exist.

Variant B: Few-shot (style guided by examples)

```
You generate startup ideas for college campuses in India.
Follow this exact format: Name | Pitch (max 15 words) | Twist (what makes it new).

Example 1:
HostelHaat | Weekend home-cooked meals from local families to hostel students |
Meals priced by a monthly subscription, not per order

Example 2:
BackBenchBytes | Recorded 5-minute recaps of every lecture, made by toppers |
Recaps are auto-tagged to the syllabus unit

Now give 3 new ideas on the theme: placements and internships.
```

Output

- ResumeRoast | Peer-reviewed resume feedback from seniors placed in top companies | Reviewers earn points redeemable for interview-prep sessions
- InternRadar | Alerts for internships matched to your skills and semester | Filters out listings that require more experience than they advertise
- MockMitra | Free mock interviews with alumni on 15-minute slots | Every session ends with a scorecard that tracks your growth

Observation: consistent format, specific to the theme, and every idea carries a twist.

Variant C: Few-shot + persona and tone

```
Act as a witty startup mentor who roasts lazy ideas but cheers on bold ones.
Use the same format as the examples below, then add one line: "Mentor says:".

Example:
HostelHaat | Weekend home-cooked meals from local families to hostel students |
Monthly subscription instead of per-order pricing
Mentor says: Finally, food that does not taste like regret.

Give 3 new ideas on the theme: placements and internships.
```

Output

- OfferOrNot | Compare job offers on salary, growth and culture in one score | Uses real alumni reviews instead of company brochures. Mentor says: Because "dream company" is not a spreadsheet.
- GapYearGuru | Turn career gaps into portfolio projects with weekly challenges | Hiring managers see a project timeline, not a blank space. Mentor says: Gaps are fine, wasted gaps are not.
- ColdMailCoach | Writes and tests cold emails to recruiters on LinkedIn | A/B tests subject lines and shows reply rates. Mentor says: Stop sending "Dear Sir/Madam" to humans.

Comparison

Aspect	A: Zero-shot	B: Few-shot	C: Few-shot + persona
Tone	Flat, neutral	Professional	Playful, opinionated
Creativity	Low, familiar ideas	Medium, includes twists	High, memorable voice
Detail	One line each	Pitch + twist	Pitch + twist + mentor line
Format control	None	Strong	Strong
Best for	Quick brainstorm	Structured pitches	Engaging content or demos

Takeaway: examples control structure, persona and tone control voice. Combining both gave the most creative and most consistent results. Temperature and wording changes can be tested further by re-running Variant C with different examples.